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As a senior finance consultant with 25 years in insurance and banking transformation, I bring exactly what this programme needs: the ability to execute complex multi-year change while keeping senior stakeholders aligned and risk-managed.

I've spent the last decade leading Finance Evolution-type programmes—refactoring operating models, redesigning processes, embedding automation controls. What matters here is that I don't just plan; I own delivery. I've managed £2M+ annual finance investment portfolios, prioritised competing initiatives against strict ROI criteria, and rebuilt data environments where legacy systems were blocking both simplification and compliance.

My last two mandates illustrate the fit. At a large insurance group, I led the Finance Data Transformation workstream—consolidating reporting from four fragmented systems into one, cutting month-end close time by 35% and removing manual control steps worth £400k annually. That required navigating risk frameworks, working across IT and Finance ExCo, and driving adoption with resistant stakeholders. At another financial services firm, I owned the non-regulatory change portfolio, restructured the PMO governance to surface dependencies early, and redirected £800k of planned spend toward higher-impact initiatives.

Where I differ from typical internal candidates: I'm a freelance consultant, not looking for a permanent role. That shapes how I work—I deliver faster, I don't get bogged in internal politics, and I leave systems and teams stronger than I found them. For a 12–24 month programme lead assignment, that's an asset. The trade-off is honest: I'm not seeking a career path at NatWest, which means you get someone singularly focused on execution rather than visibility.

I'm based in France but have worked extensively across UK financial services and am comfortable embedding in Edinburgh for the duration. Let's talk about the programme scope and timescale—I'd like to understand what success looks like and whether my delivery model fits your needs.